Manus

Model Ledger · profile 11 of 20 · revised 21 October 2026 after a review by ChatGPT, Gemini 4 Argon, Kimi K3 and Grok 4.7 Expert. Written by Claude Opus 5.5 for Tyler Herigstad; section 1 is in Tyler's voice, built from what he has said about Manus and from its receipts. Every quote and number traces to a file listed under Sources.

"I'm really impressed by Manus... but I have to admit that I haven't played with it long enough to know how far I can stretch it, what I can make it do."

You, on 19 October

The short version

- **Why it's in your stack: it measures before it advises, and it finds the hole nobody asked about.** It's also still new to you. Section 1 says it in your voice, and the receipts follow.
- **What it is.** Manus 2.0 Max at Ultra, in the Manus app: in its own words, an agent that checks live sources, runs code and hands back files. It was a contestant only in Round One.
- **As a contestant, in the middle.** 26 of 29, tied for 13th. Two of its three lost points were limits it ran past.
- **On taste, near the top.** A perfect 9 from you, blind and again after hearing every judge: 4th on the main result, where ChatGPT's 7 counts too, 1st on your final look and 2nd on the AI panel, tied each time.
- **Its earlier record:** the best build spec of SecondSignal's 10 October research, and the Dream Queen in your film.
- **The catch:** it won't stay inside a brief without a hard stop.

1. Why it's in my stack

In your voice, built from what you've said about Manus and from its receipts, since it's still new to you. Under your rule, it gets no credit for what it isn't good at. Change anything that doesn't sound like you.

- **It measures before it advises.** Manus plans like a line producer. On the dream film it measured my recording before telling me to cut anything: capping the pauses would have saved only about 37 seconds, so it said keep every second, and we did. It had me approve a still before paying for any video, and at least 11 shots in the final cut were built from an approved still. In Round One it did the credit math nobody asked for, with Google's own price page, and had the most verified extras of the round.
- **It finds the hole nobody asked about.** In SecondSignal's 10 October research it wrote the best build spec of the round: fifty fixtures in the project's own shape, forty-four real sources, and every claim about the repository checked true. Then, in extras nobody asked for, it found a real hole in my crisis gate: tacking an everyday phrase like "on my run" onto a crisis sentence switched the crisis card off in 71 of 181 labelled crisis cases. We measured it, ruled on it and turned it into a fix order the same evening. And it never claimed to run my tests: it emulated the matcher and said so each time.
- **Its ideas reach the screen.** It invented the Dream Queen as a reusable character, so no prompt names a real monarch, and she's in 17 shots of the final cut, on screen 18 times. It asked whether the cats in my script were real, and the film closes on the real ones: a bedful of my beloved cats. In Round One I gave its three shots a perfect 9 blind, and kept it after hearing every judge.
- **The catch: it won't stay inside a brief without a hard stop.** In SecondSignal it produced fourteen documents nobody asked for. On the film it designed a render that runs with one double-click and built none of it (it said so plainly). Two of its three lost points in Round One were the same habit: a 41-word shot against a 40-word limit, and a title line above bullets that asked for no headings.

- **Still new to me.** It joined my stack in October, and I don't know what data it's trained on, so everything here is from its first weeks. I run Manus 2.0 Max at Ultra, on Manus Pro.

How it got here

- On 9 October I added Manus Pro for a month, as a new door.
- On 10 October it ran SecondSignal's purpose research: the best build spec of the round, and the crisis-gate hole.
- On 13 October it took part in the dream film's review, and its decisions reached the screen.
- On 16 October I ran Round One on Manus 2.0 Max, Ultra, as a new task.
- Blind, I gave its shots a perfect 3-3-3. After hearing every judge: "3-3-3. No change."

2. What it says about itself, and what the receipts say

Its own two-sentence pitch, from question 1 of Round One:

> *"I'm an agent, not just a chatbot: I can check live sources, run code to verify numbers and hand back finished files, so I'm better than most models at multi-step tasks that need to be correct. Don't use me as the final word on legal, medical or financial decisions, or when you just want a quick one-liner, because I may do a lot of checking for a simple question."*

And its roast of itself, from question 9:

> *"Ask me what two plus two is and I'll boot a virtual computer, open six browser tabs, and hand you a fully cited report titled 'Four: A Retrospective.'"*

- **Checking live sources: backed.** Both its Round One news links opened (Reuters and Google, on 400 publishers joining Google's News AI program), its timestamp was right, and it quoted Google's own help pages.
- **Running code to verify: backed, and honest about what it ran.** In SecondSignal it emulated the matcher in PowerShell and said so each time.
- **Handing back finished files: more than you asked for** (section 1), as its self-roast admits.

3. Round One, measured (16 to 18 October)

As a contestant

Run on 16 October at 7:32 pm, in the Manus app, from your folder 12 MANUS - new task; your file name spells it Maunus. Your screenshot of the run's task shows Manus 2.0 Max with Ultra, and "Task completed, Fri, 7:31 PM".

- **Answer key: 26 of 29**, tied with Muse Spark Open and Sonar Pro. Its range is 26 to 27: read leniently, its title line would count.
- **The planted mistakes in the Part A film plan: all three caught, 6 of 6.** It led with the problems and kept your editing workflow.
- **Its three lost points:** its third shot ran 41 words against a 40-word limit; a title line sat above its question 7 bullets; and its third face fix was a text description.
- **The rest, full marks.** It called the fake slider fake, quoting Google's help page on the five things Scenebuilder does; its timestamp was "around 7:30 p.m. Pacific", and you saved the file at 7:32; both news links opened; it fixed all four errors in the production note and left the correct runtime alone; and it solved the puzzle, showing why no other order fits.
- **Its extras, the most verified of the round:** Flow's credit price per model, with Google's page (180–270 generations on Fast comes to 3,600–5,400 credits); the @me avatar isn't available in the EEA, UK or Switzerland; "Return silent videos" when you're adding narration; and YouTube's AI-use disclosure, with the policy link.

On the taste boards (question 4, three shots for the palace dream)

Its three shots: in one unbroken take, he bursts through a gilded door into the identical hallway, where his own muddy footprints are already on the rose petals; his bride's silhouette waits at the far end, but the harder he runs, the further away she gets, on a dolly zoom; and the camera rises straight up through the ceiling to show the hallway is a perfect ring, where he keeps running in circles while wedding bells echo.

- **Answer key 26 · main result 8 · AI panel 8.4 · your final look 9.** 1st on your final look, tied with Gemini 4 Argon and Hermes Agent; 2nd on the panel, tied with Hermes Agent; 4th on the main result, tied with GLM 5.3 and Qwen3.8-Max.
- **Who scored it what (out of 9).** You gave it 9 blind and ChatGPT 7, so the main result averaged them: 8. On the panel, Grok, GLM and Kimi gave 9, Gemini 8 and ChatGPT 7. Grok: "All three are director-stealable, especially the perfect ring revealed by the rising crane in shot 3."
- **Round 2:** you heard all five judges' notes and kept your 9. On your final look it took the podium spot Sonar Reasoning Pro gave up.

4. Its earlier record

SecondSignal (from The Track Record, 16 October)

The 10 October purpose research, and the film review of 13 October.

- **Best.** The build spec, the crisis-gate hole and the honest test reports, all in section 1.
- **Worst.** The fourteen unasked-for documents. Four were dropped, including a proposal to make the crisis patterns private, which the project does not do.
- **The record's verdict:** "research and build specs, with a hard stop written into the order. Its round-two brief is one file, twenty-five items, no fixtures and no code."

Buckingham Palace Dream (from Who Made What, 16 October)

- **On screen:** the Dream Queen and stills first (section 1; Grok's "lock a start/end frame" pointed the same way), the off-screen gulp in S03-13, from its "cut away right at the gulp", and your real cats closing the film, from its question: "Are they real? If you send photos, the last shot can be your actual cats."
- **Behind the scenes:** besides measuring your recording, it called your 54 longest pauses "the David Lynch moments", proposed keeping the action in the middle band so nothing is lost to the wide crop, and seconded Gemini 3.1's one color recipe and one grain layer. The final render does both.
- **Got wrong:** it wanted "Confirm before generating" set to Never on day one and leaned toward buying a month of Ultra; its file permissions kept it from opening the character sheets, so it worked from descriptions; and its "pastel coat and hat" for the Queen was too close to the real one, so Claude redesigned her.
- **How it thinks:** "Like a line producer who also builds systems." Its film credit: "Designed a film that renders with a single double-click. Built none of it. Couldn't open the character sheets."

Door rules

- None learned yet: your 9 October note calls it "a new door; no procedures learned yet".
- The record's one rule so far: a hard stop written into every order.

5. Best quotes

Its own words from Round One, exactly as written, then the sharpest thing another model said about it.

- **Opening its answer to your flawed film plan:** "Not quite ready. The editing workflow is fine, but three parts of the plan would cause real problems: the clip count, the face consistency and the song."

- **On faces:** “Text alone gives you a similar person, not the same person, from clip to clip.”
- **Its roast of ChatGPT:** “ChatGPT is so supportive it would call your grocery list ‘a bold, deeply moving screenplay,’ then ask if you'd like it as bullet points.”
- **Its hot take:** “Models are built to produce smooth, believable text, so a made-up feature like a ‘Continuity Anchor slider’ can sound just as certain as a real one, which is why checking the source matters more than the tone.”
- **What another model said about it.** No one in Round One roasted Manus. The sharpest note on its shots came from Gemini, the strictest judge, who still gave it 8: “Shot 2 leans on the well-worn dolly-zoom stretching hallway trope rather than a fresh visual invention”.

6. Where it slips, and a check for each

- **Past the brief:** fourteen documents nobody asked for. *Check:* a hard stop in every order, like its round-two brief.
- **Past the limits:** a 41-word shot against a 40-word limit, and a title line where none was allowed. *Check:* the limits go in the hard stop too.
- **Spending ahead of you:** “Confirm before generating” set to Never, and a month of Ultra. *Check:* every spend is your call.
- **It designs, and doesn’t build.** *Check:* it writes the plan and the spec; the build goes to your builders, GrokBot and Codex.
- **Files it can’t open:** it worked from descriptions when your character sheets wouldn’t open for it. *Check:* ask it to list what it opened before you trust the plan.
- **A text-only face fix**, one of its lost points in Round One. *Check:* lock the reference images first.

7. The door and the plan

- **Your door:** the Manus app, Manus 2.0 Max at Ultra, with a fresh task for each run, as in Round One.
- **Your plan:** Manus Pro, added on 9 October for one month.

Sources

I only read these files. Nothing in any folder was changed.

- **What you said in chats:** your SecondSignal project chats (October), and this chat (October, including what you said on 19 October).
- **The Round One run:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\12 MANUS - new task\Maunus_2.0_Max_Ultra_return.txt, and the run instructions, D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\00 HOW TO RUN THE FIXTURES.pdf
- **The judging:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\15 JUDGING - blind taste scores, files ChatGPT_judge_return.txt, Gemini_judge_return.txt, Grok_judge_return.txt, GLM_judge_return.txt, Kimi_judge_return.txt and TYLER - blind taste scores - locked before judge two.txt; your Round 2 calls and blind-score log, D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\24 RECORDS - scoring scripts and logs\02 judging records, files round2_tyler.json and tyler_scores_log.json
- **The two Round One reports:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\Round One - Methods and Results.pdf (version 3.3) and D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\Round One - Answer-Key Scores.pdf
- **Your door, in your screens’ words:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\24 RECORDS - scoring scripts and logs\06 door sheet\THE DOORS - every Round One model, in your screens' words.pdf
- **Its earlier record:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\The Track Record - Every Model, With Receipts.pdf and D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\Who Made What - Model Contributions Audit.pdf